escapees, Chinese mortars opened up. After resisting the Chinese for an hour, the remaining troops broke contact and retreated to the Assam Rifles position at Tungri. From Poshing-la the track towards the south first descends sharply for 150 metres after which there is an equally sharp climb towards a rhododendron and fir-covered spur on which the Assam Rifles were deployed. With the Chinese in close pursuit, the combined Guards and Assam Rifles group fought it out till 7.30 p.m. During this period, a situation report was flashed to 48 Brigade at Bomdila, after which Tungri was abandoned and the men fell back on Lagam where they met two more companies of 5 Guards who had been moving towards Poshing-la. The men broke up into small parties to evade the harassing Chinese mortar fire and fell back further towards Thembang and Bomdila.

For the Indian troops deployed at various places to stop Chinese infiltration along the flanks of Se-la, 15 November was proving to be a disastrous day. At the 4 Division HQ, more and more red flags denoting the presence of Chinese troops were appearing as Indian soldiers started making contact with the enemy. Yet, there was an unreal calm in the vicinity of Dirang Dzong. So much so that even then Division HQ had not thought of setting up defences around its own location.

The 1 Sikh patrol had reported from Se-la that there was a large concentration of Chinese troops around Lunguthang. Accordingly, orders were issued to 4 Rajput's Alpha Company dug in at PT 3446 to send a patrol to Yonggyap-la. On the wireless, the 2IC, Major Trilok Nath, told Nair to send the artillery officer, Second Lieutenant Choudhary, along with the patrol under the command of a JCO, Jemadar Rai Singh. The patrol moved out at 7 p.m. in thick fog and after failing to make contact with the Chinese began to retrace its steps towards the company location. At some point, Choudhary insisted on taking a break and brewing some tea. There was an argument between him and Rai Singh who finally detached a section to protect the officer while he continued ahead with the rest of the party. Shortly afterwards, the Chinese, who had seen the fire, quickly closed in and killed the lieutenant and four men of the protection party. Only Sepoy Ganga Din managed to escape the carnage. After wandering around through the night, the soldier eventually got back and reported to Nair on the morning of 16 November.

On the evening of 15 November, 4 Rajput was celebrating its Zojila day (to mark its victory at Zojila in 1948). Major J. R. Saigal who was present